

Incident Management Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Phase 4 – Project Planning Phase

1. Planning Objective

The planning phase converts the design into an implementation roadmap. The project is developed incrementally in a ServiceNow Personal Developer Instance, with configuration, testing and validation performed in controlled stages.

2. Work Breakdown Structure

1. Configure Remote Access service.
2. Configure Corporate VPN service offering.
3. Create and classify incident scenario.
4. Configure assignment and escalation.
5. Create and manage child incidents.
6. Integrate Change Management.
7. Create or attach Knowledge articles.
8. Configure and validate SLA tracking.
9. Perform end-to-end testing.
10. Prepare final documentation and evidence.

3. Proposed Timeline

Week	Activity	Output
1	Ideation and requirements	Problem statement and requirements
2	Design and process planning	Architecture and process design
3	Service and incident configuration	Core incident process
4	Escalation, child incident and change integration	Integrated lifecycle
5	Knowledge, SLA testing and validation	Validated solution and documentation

4. Resources

- ServiceNow Personal Developer Instance.
- ServiceNow Service Operations Workspace.
- Incident Management capability.
- Knowledge and Change Management capabilities.
- SLA configuration and Task SLA records.

- Test users and sample incident data.
- Documentation and GitHub repository for project artifacts.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Service Desk	Log, classify and initially process incidents.
Network / Level 2	Investigate and resolve escalated technical incidents.
Change Management	Manage changes required for resolution.
Knowledge Management	Maintain reusable troubleshooting information.
Project Owner	Configure, test, document and validate the solution.

6. Risk Management

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Incorrect configuration	Workflow may not behave as expected.	Test each configuration change before proceeding.
Permission limitations	Some actions may not be available.	Use appropriate roles and validate access.
Automation side effects	Parent-child/state behavior may be inconsistent.	Test lifecycle transitions with controlled records.
SLA configuration issues	SLA status may be unexpected.	Validate SLA start, pause, completion and visibility.
PDI availability	Development work may be interrupted.	Keep documentation and project artifacts backed up.

7. Testing Strategy

- Unit-level validation of configuration items.
- Functional testing of incident creation, assignment and state transitions.
- Integration testing of Incident with Change and Knowledge.
- Parent-child testing for resolution synchronization.
- SLA verification using Task SLA records.
- End-to-end scenario validation.

8. Planned Deliverables

- Configured service and service offering.
- Incident lifecycle scenario.
- Assignment and escalation behavior.
- Parent-child relationship.
- Linked change request.
- Knowledge evidence.
- SLA tracking evidence.

- Testing and validation results.
- Project documentation.

9. Documentation and Evidence Plan

Evidence	Recommended Section
Service and service offering	Design / Development
Incident creation and details	Development
Assignment and escalation	Development
Child incident and parent resolution	Development
Change request	Development
Knowledge article	Development
SLA tracking	Development
Final validation	Development

10. Planning Outcome

The plan provides a practical sequence for implementing, testing and documenting the ServiceNow Incident Management automation while preserving traceability between modules.